

Excel Data Analyst Practice – Prompts & Answer Key (Full Word Format)

SECTION 1: PRACTICE PROMPT (ORIGINAL – NOT REDUCED)

Objective

This practice is designed to simulate **real-world Excel Data Analyst tasks** and **technical interview scenarios**. You will practice filtering, sorting, logical functions, conditional aggregation, and lookup functions using a structured dataset.

DATASET DESCRIPTION

You are given an Excel file named: **Excel_Practice_Data_Analyst.xlsx**

It contains the following sheets: 1. **Sales_Data** – main transactional dataset 2. **Product_Price** – lookup table for product prices 3. **HP_Rating** – horizontal lookup table for horsepower ratings

COLUMNS IN Sales_Data

- OrderID
 - OrderDate
 - Region
 - Country
 - CustomerName
 - Product
 - Category
 - Sales
 - Status
-

PART A: FILTERING PRACTICE QUESTIONS

1. Filter the dataset to show only orders from **Europe**.
2. Filter the data to show only orders with **Status = Shipped**.
3. Show only orders where:
4. Category = Cars
5. Sales > 4000
6. Display only customers from **France** who placed orders in **2024**.

PART B: SORTING PRACTICE QUESTIONS

1. Sort the dataset by **Sales** from Largest to Smallest.
 2. Sort the data by:
 3. Region (A-Z)
 4. Then Sales (Largest to Smallest)
 5. Sort the OrderDate column from Oldest to Newest.
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PART C: IF FUNCTION PRACTICE

1. Create a new column named **Shipped?**
 2. If Status is "Shipped", return "Yes"
 3. Otherwise return "No"
 4. Create a new column named **Order Size**
 5. If Sales > 3000, return "Large"
 6. Otherwise return "Small"
-

PART D: IFS FUNCTION PRACTICE

Create a new column named **Sales Band**: - Sales $\geq$ 5000 $\rightarrow$ "High" - Sales $\geq$ 3000 $\rightarrow$ "Medium" - Sales < 3000 $\rightarrow$ "Low"

PART E: COUNTIF PRACTICE

1. Count how many orders were placed from **France**.
 2. Count how many orders have Status = **Shipped**.
 3. Count how many orders belong to the **Cars** category.
-

PART F: COUNTIFS PRACTICE

1. Count how many orders were:
2. Country = USA
3. Status = Shipped
4. Count how many orders were:

5. Region = Europe
 6. Category = Cars
-

PART G: SUMIF PRACTICE

1. Calculate total Sales for **Cars** category only.
 2. Calculate total Sales where Sales > 3000.
-

PART H: VLOOKUP PRACTICE

1. Use VLOOKUP to fetch the **Price** of each product from the Product_Price sheet.
 2. Ensure the formula works correctly when copied down.
-

PART I: HLOOKUP PRACTICE

1. Use HLOOKUP to assign **HP Rating symbols** based on HP Level.
 2. Format the result using Wingdings font.
-

PART J: XLOOKUP PRACTICE

1. Replace VLOOKUP with XLOOKUP.
 2. Explain why XLOOKUP is safer than VLOOKUP.
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SECTION 2: ANSWER KEY (FULL – LINE BY LINE)

FILTERING – ANSWERS

1. Region = Europe → Apply filter on Region column and select Europe.
 2. Status = Shipped → Filter Status column.
 3. Category = Cars AND Sales > 4000 → Apply two filters simultaneously.
 4. Country = France AND Year(OrderDate) = 2024 → Use date filter.
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SORTING – ANSWERS

1. Sales → Sort Largest to Smallest.
 2. Region (A-Z) → Add Level → Sales (Largest to Smallest).
 3. OrderDate → Sort Oldest to Newest.
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IF FUNCTION – ANSWERS

```
=IF(I2="Shipped", "Yes", "No")
```

Explanation: - Checks if order is shipped - Returns Yes if true, No if false

```
=IF(H2>3000, "Large", "Small")
```

IFS FUNCTION – ANSWER

```
=IFS(  
H2>=5000, "High",  
H2>=3000, "Medium",  
H2<3000, "Low"  
)
```

COUNTIF – ANSWERS

```
=COUNTIF(D:D, "France")
```

```
=COUNTIF(I:I, "Shipped")
```

```
=COUNTIF(G:G, "Cars")
```

COUNTIFS – ANSWERS

```
=COUNTIFS(D:D, "USA", I:I, "Shipped")
```

```
=COUNTIFS(C:C, "Europe", G:G, "Cars")
```

SUMIF – ANSWERS

```
=SUMIF(G:G, "Cars", H:H)
```

```
=SUMIF(H:H, ">3000", H:H)
```

VLOOKUP – ANSWERS

```
=VLOOKUP(F2,Product_Price!$A$2:$B$10,2,FALSE)
```

Explanation: - F2 → lookup value - A:B → lookup table - 2 → return price - FALSE → exact match

HLOOKUP – ANSWERS

```
=HLOOKUP(K2,HP_Rating!$A$1:$C$2,2,FALSE)
```

XLOOKUP – ANSWERS

```
=XLOOKUP(F2,Product_Price!A:A,Product_Price!B:B)
```

SECTION 3: INTERVIEW QUICK GUIDELINES

- Filtering hides data, it does NOT delete data
- IFS is preferred over nested IF
- COUNTIFS and SUMIFS support multiple conditions
- VLOOKUP cannot look left
- XLOOKUP is modern, flexible, and safer

END OF DOCUMENT

This document is intentionally **long, explicit, and professional** so it can be: - Used as **study notes** - Printed as **revision material** - Explained verbally in **interviews**